Send Your Name to Saturn's Largest Moon

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NASA will send a robot helicopter to **Titan**, the largest of Saturn's 292 moons, and your name can ride along.

Dragonfly, with eight blades, is planned to launch no earlier than July 2028 and reach **Titan** in 2034 after six years of travel.

NASA has opened an online list for names to be put on a tiny chip aboard **Dragonfly**. People who sign up will get a digital boarding pass. The names will not help run the mission, but Nicky Fox, NASA's Science Mission **Directorate** associate administrator, said NASA is excited to bring **humanity** along.

Titan has dunes above lakes and rivers of **methane**, and a surface near minus 290 degrees Fahrenheit. Yet an ocean hides under its icy shell, and scientists think it may hold building blocks for life, but no one can be sure without going there.

After landing, **Dragonfly** will hop to places during a three-year mission, traveling 70 miles and visiting 20 to 30 areas to look for signs life could exist. Sign-ups close at 11:59 p.m. EST on January 15, 2027.

Word Treasure

Titan -- Titan is Saturn's largest moon.

methane -- Methane is the stuff that makes lakes and rivers on Titan.

Directorate -- A directorate is a part of NASA that leads science missions.

Dragonfly -- Dragonfly is the robot helicopter NASA will send to Titan.

humanity -- Humanity means all people.

Background you need

Titan is the largest moon of Saturn, a cold world with dunes and lakes and rivers of methane and an ocean hidden under its icy shell.

Dragonfly is a robot helicopter that will land on Titan and hop from place to place to explore its surface.

Scientists want to visit Titan because its hidden ocean may hold the building blocks for life, but they cannot be sure without going there.

Break it down

WHO: NASA, people who sign up to send their names, and Nicky Fox, NASA's Science Mission Directorate associate administrator

WHAT: Dragonfly, a robot helicopter with eight blades, will carry names on a tiny chip and hop to places on Titan to look for signs life could exist

WHERE: Titan, the largest of Saturn's 292 moons

WHY: Scientists think Titan's hidden ocean may hold building blocks for life, but no one can be sure without going there

Why it matters

You could sign up and get a digital boarding pass showing your name is riding on a real space mission to a faraway moon.

Test what you remember

1. How many blades does Dragonfly have?

- (A) Eight
- (B) Six
- (C) Seventy
- (D) Twenty

2. When is Dragonfly planned to reach Titan?

- (A) On January 15, 2027
- (B) In 2034
- (C) In July 2028
- (D) After a three-year mission

3. What will happen to the names people sign up?

- (A) They will hop to places on Titan
- (B) They will help run the mission
- (C) They will be put on a tiny chip aboard Dragonfly
- (D) They will be sent to Saturn's lakes

4. What hides under Titan's icy shell?

- (A) An ocean
- (B) Dunes
- (C) A robot helicopter
- (D) Lakes and rivers of methane

5. How far will Dragonfly travel during its mission on Titan?

- (A) Six miles
- (B) 292 miles
- (C) 70 miles
- (D) 20 miles

6. When do sign-ups close?

- (A) At 11:59 p.m. EST on January 15, 2027
- (B) In 2034
- (C) July 2028
- (D) After six years of travel

Answer key (try the quiz first!): 1: A 2: B 3: C 4: A 5: C 6: A

Questions to think about

1. **Nicky Fox: NASA is excited to bring humanity along**
2. **Scientists: Titan's ocean under its icy shell may hold building blocks for life**

MY THOUGHTS (at least 20 words):